ELARA · REVIEW PROTOTYPES · 22 OCT 2026

Explorar and Círculos, one frame

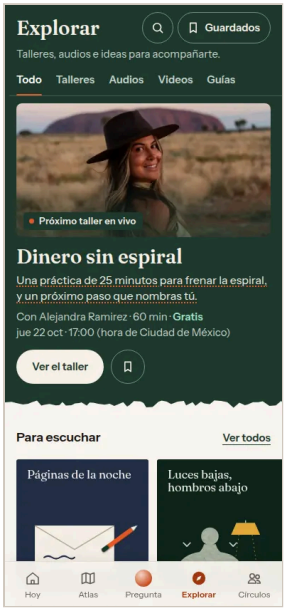
The owner said: "make sure circles and explore have some coherence, they seem both way too off." This pass gives both tab-level screens the same header band, sub-tabs, torn edge, page, cards, chips, buttons and tab bar. Each keeps its own content and identity.

Decisions

- **One primary:** forest #1F3A2E with cream text (10.98:1). On the band it inverts to cream with forest text. Ember and terracotta are accents only.
- **One band:** #1F3A2E (production `buttonForest`), Fraunces 600 28/34 (production `typeScale.title`), the same pill buttons, underline sub-tabs and torn edge. Círculos' sun-and-hills mark is gone.
- **One page and card:** page #F9F5EF (`background`); card #FFFDF9, 1 px #D6CBBC, radius 8, padding 16. Sections 18/24 600; metadata 13/18 #635A54.
- **One chip, one tab bar,** from production `TabBar.tsx` metrics and labels.

Checks after the pass. Explorar: flows 164/164, AA 2 860/2 860 and layout 52/52 (two stale steps updated; see the checks page). Círculos: 390/390 flows, 0 contrast, 0 clipping, 0 small targets.

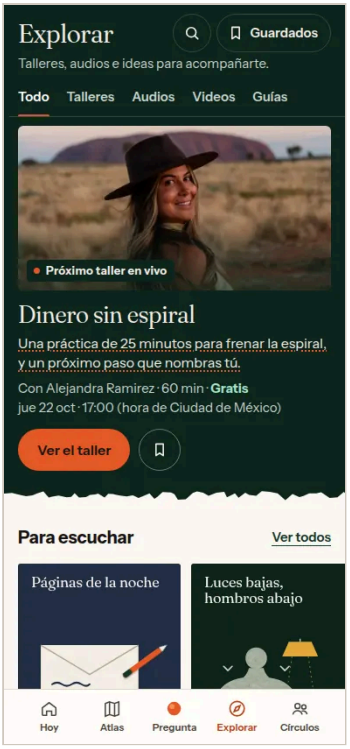
Every image in this document is a browser render (headless Chromium) of the prototypes, not phone evidence. Sample data.





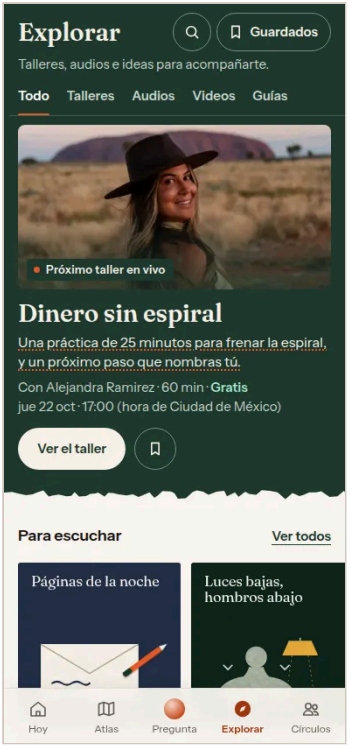
Same app? First screen of each tab, side by side

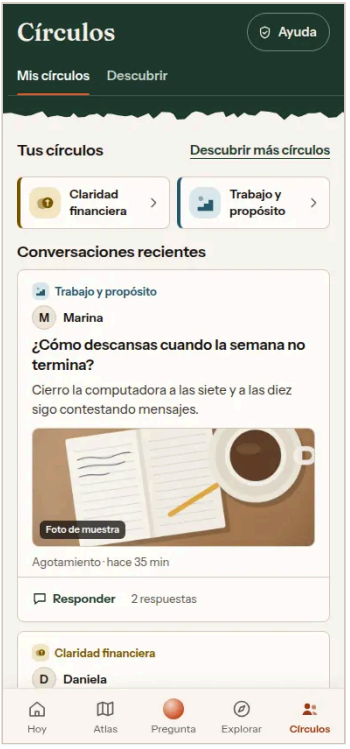
Before (v2b and v2)





After (this pass)

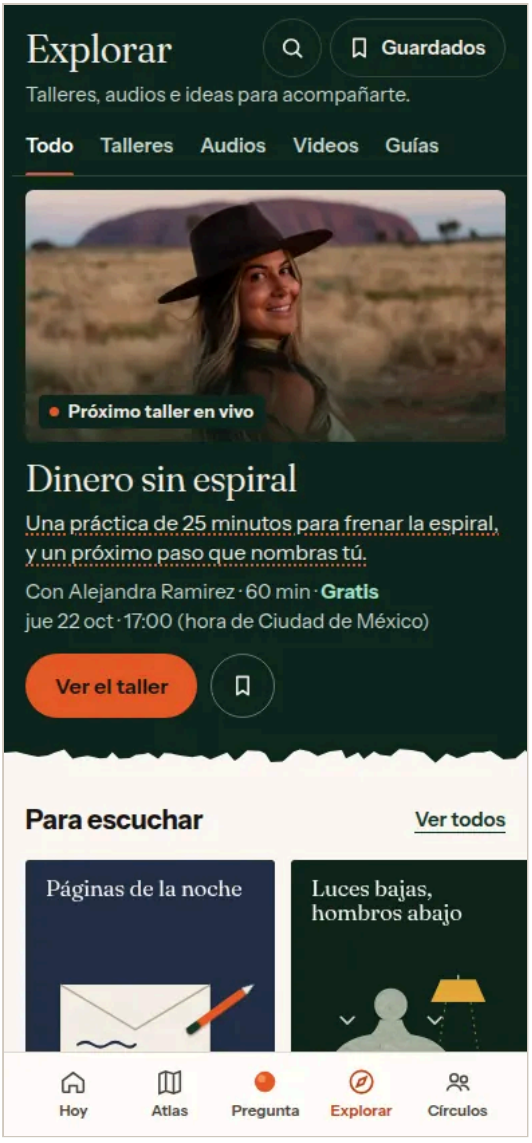




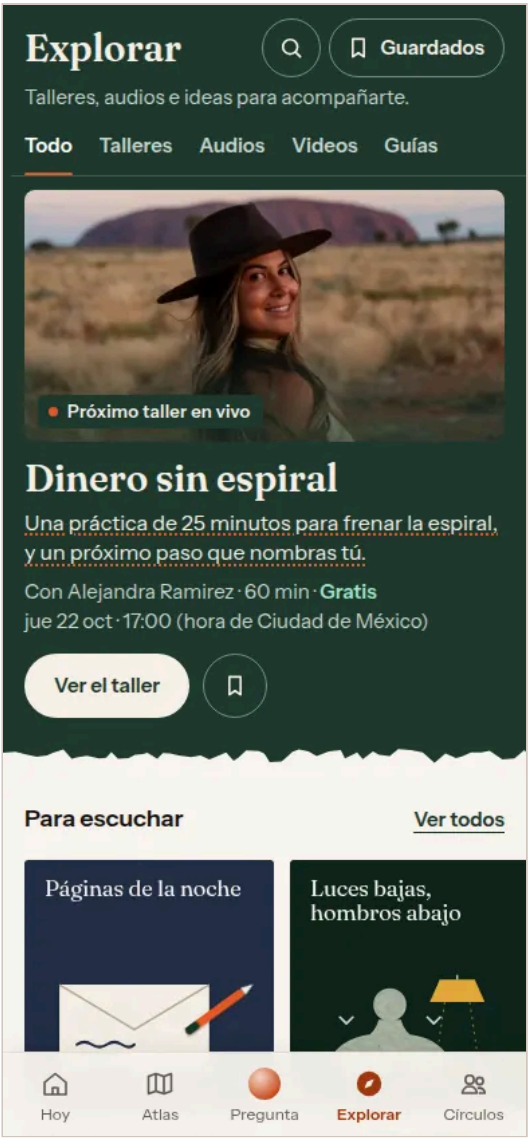
Left: Explorar overview. Right: Mis círculos. 390 × 844. Círculos' simulated device insets are set to 0 on this page only (its own review hooks), because Explorar does not simulate them. Logo-removed test: the after pair reads as one app, and still as Elara. See the last pages.

Explorar · overview (Todo)

Before



After



- Band #0E261D to #1F3A2E; «Explorar» Fraunces 360/30 to 600/28.
- «Ver el taller»: ember with ink text to the band primary (cream with forest text).
- Section heading 20/700 to 18/600; metadata 14 px #5A524C to 13 px #635A54.
- Page #FCF9F3 to #F9F5EF; the shared tab bar.

390 × 844 browser renders (headless Chromium), not phone screenshots. Sample data.

Explorar · a category (Guías)

Before



After



- The band without the feature: title, sub-tabs, 14 px foot, torn edge. Círculos now uses exactly this shape.
- Rules #E4DACB to #D6CBBC; guide titles Fraunces 420 to 600; metadata 13 px #635A54.
- Rule-separated rows kept.

390 × 844 browser renders (headless Chromium), not phone screenshots. Sample data.

Explorar · workshop detail

Before



After



- Band and photo shade re-tinted to #1F3A2E; title Fraunces 600.
- Price box: white, radius 6 to card #FFFDF9, radius 8, #D6CBBC border.
- «Reservar mi lugar»: ember to forest with cream text.

390 × 844 browser renders (headless Chromium), not phone screenshots. Sample data.

Explorar · audio detail

Before



After

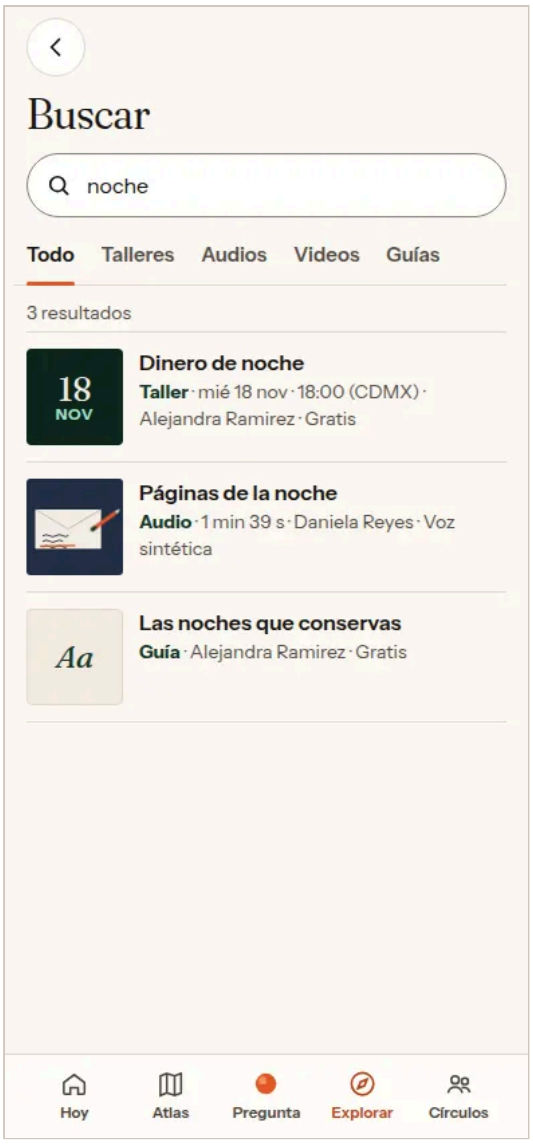


- «Escuchar»: ember to forest; title Fraunces 600.
- Facts and player times in the metadata style; the cover is unchanged (Explorar's own art).

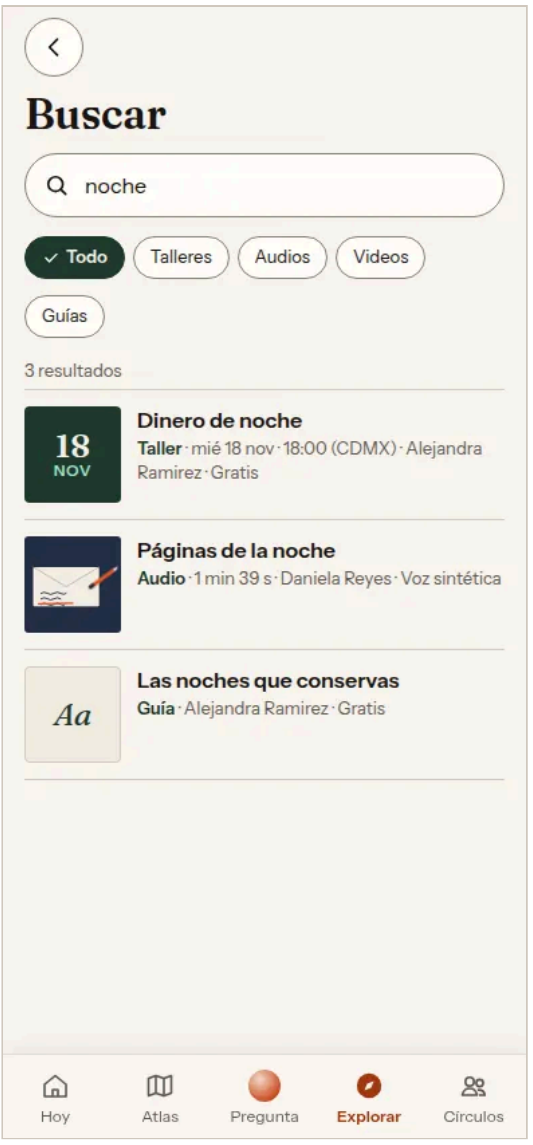
390 × 844 browser renders (headless Chromium), not phone screenshots. Sample data.

Explorar · search (format filters)

Before



After



- Format filters: underline tabs to the shared filter chip (the same chip as Círculos' section and Descubrir filters).
- Search field: 1.5 px #8B7F74 to 1 px #8E8174 on the card fill.

390 × 844 browser renders (headless Chromium), not phone screenshots. Sample data.

Círculos · Mis círculos

Before



After



- «Círculos» 600/24 to 600/28; the sun-and-hills mark removed.
- Pill switch to underline sub-tabs in the band (white with a 3 px ember underline); 14 px foot and Explorar's torn edge.
- Page #F5EFE4 to #F9F5EF; cards radius 14 to 8, padding 14 to 16; «Descubrir más círculos» as the «Ver todos» link.
- Shared tab bar (12 px labels, pad 10, filled active glyph).

390 × 844 browser renders (headless Chromium), not phone screenshots. Círculos' simulated status area (47 px) and home indicator (34 px) are on. Sample data.

Círculos · Descubrir

Before



After

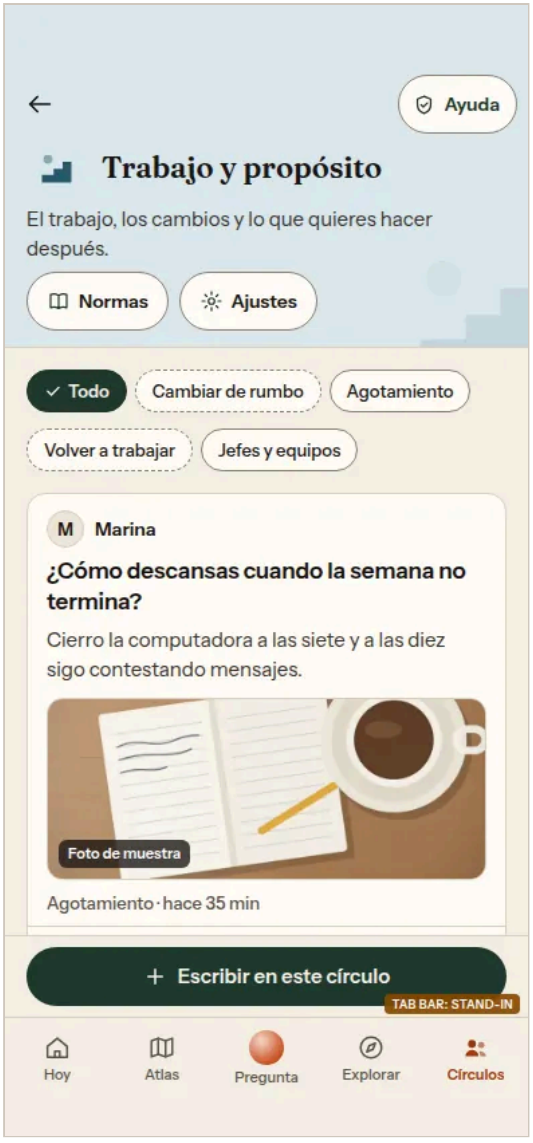


- Same band; selected «Descubrir» shown by white text and the ember underline.
- Filters are the shared chip; circle cards radius 8, padding 16, accent top edge kept.
- «Editar» as the shared link.

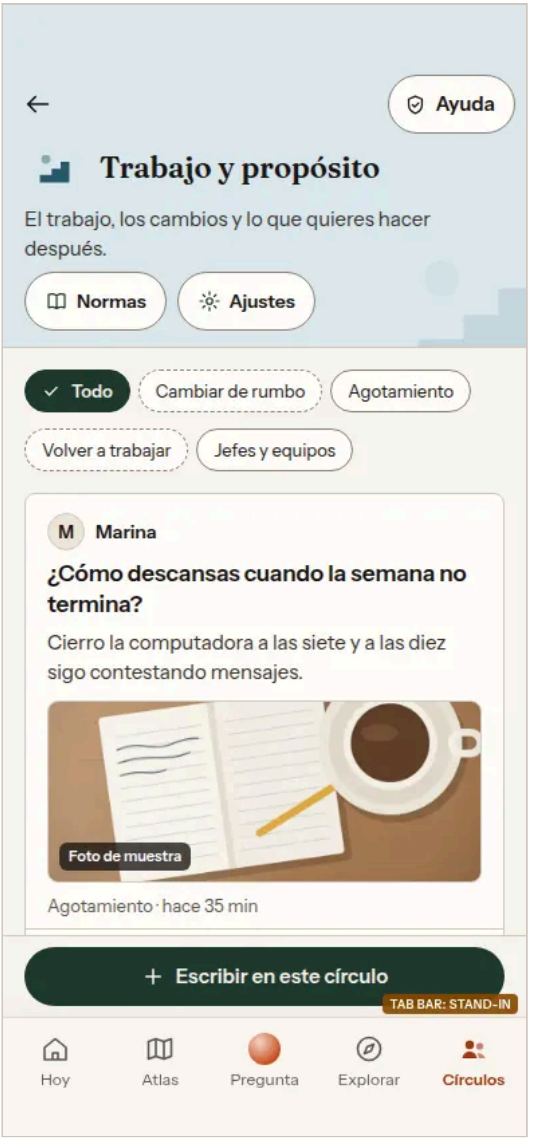
390 × 844 browser renders (headless Chromium), not phone screenshots. Círculos' simulated status area (47 px) and home indicator (34 px) are on. Sample data.

Círculos · a circle feed

Before



After

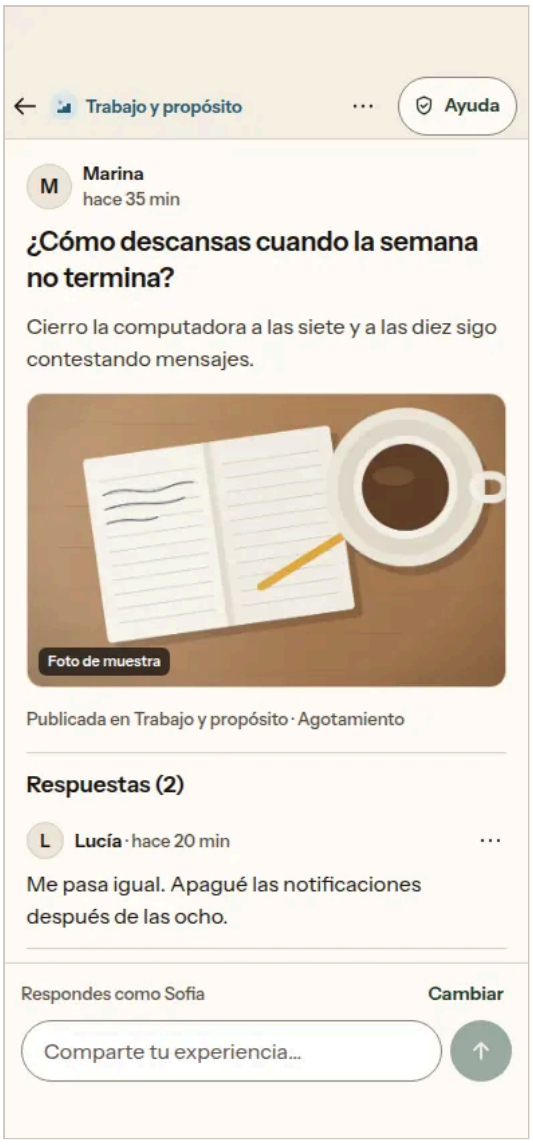


- Accent header and symbol kept (circle identity). «Ayuda» is the shared light pill.
- Section filters: the shared chip; post card radius 8, border #D6CBBC, metadata #635A54.

390 × 844 browser renders (headless Chromium), not phone screenshots. Círculos' simulated status area (47 px) and home indicator (34 px) are on. Sample data.

Círculos · a post

Before



After



- Photo radius 12 to 8; metadata colour; the light «Ayuda» pill (6 px narrower here at 320 px with large text).

390 × 844 browser renders (headless Chromium), not phone screenshots. Círculos' simulated status area (47 px) and home indicator (34 px) are on. Sample data.

Círculos · composer

Before



After



- Section picker: the shared chip; place card and photo radius 8.
- «Publicar» 50 to 48 high; forest primary unchanged.

390 × 844 browser renders (headless Chromium), not phone screenshots. Círculos' simulated status area (47 px) and home indicator (34 px) are on. Sample data.

Shared tokens

#1F3A2E
--el-band / --el-forest
Band, primary, links, selected
AA: cream 10.98

#F7F1E8
--el-on-forest
Ink on forest
AA: 10.98

#C9D4CD
--el-on-band-mut
Secondary on band
AA: 8.09

#A3E5C7
--el-mint
Ink on band only
AA: 8.57

#F9F5EF
--el-page
Page ground
AA: –

#FFFDF9
--el-card
Card, field fill
AA: –

#F1EBE2
--el-paper-2
Muted tiles
AA: meta 5.68

#D6CBBC
--el-rule
Rules, card borders
AA: decorative

#8E8174
--el-control
Chip, field edges
AA: 3.49 / 3.73

#1A1615
--el-ink
Titles, names
AA: 16.53

#3B342F
--el-body
Running text (Círculos)
AA: 12.03

#635A54
--el-meta
Metadata, resting tab
AA: 6.20 / 6.62

#E65A28
--el-ember
Underline, live dot, focus
AA: 3.44 on band

#C94A1C
--el-terra
Activity dots
AA: non-text

#A13A12
--el-terra-text
Active tab, «1 nueva»
AA: 6.18

#B3261E
--el-danger
Destructive only
AA: 6.02; white 6.54

Type roles

Role	Face	Size / line	Where
Band title	Fraunces 600	28/34	«Explorar», «Círculos»
Display headings	Fraunces 600	Explore 28–32; Círculos 19–22	Feature, detail and circle names
Section heading	Instrument Sans 600	18/24	«Para escuchar», «Tus círculos», «Conversaciones recientes»
Label, sub-tab, link, button	Instrument Sans 600	15/20	«Mis círculos», «Ver todos», «Unirme», «Ver el taller»
Body	Instrument Sans 400	15–16	Unchanged in each
Metadata, chip label	Instrument Sans 400 (chip selected 600)	13/18	«Audio · 1 min 39 s», «Agotamiento · hace 35 min»
Tab label	Instrument Sans 400 (active 600)	12/16, scaled at most 1.15×	Tab bar

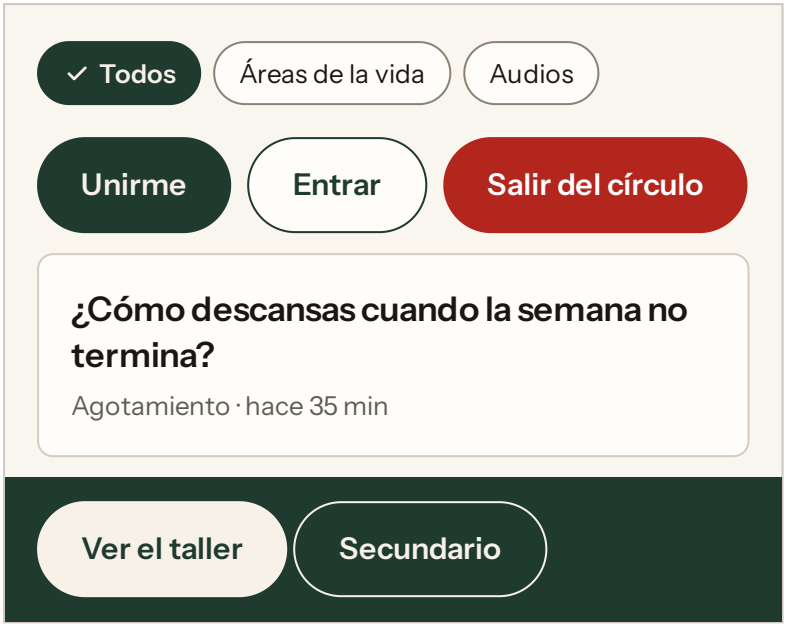
Instrument Sans stops at 600 in both, as `scale.ts` asks. Explore's 700s became 600, and the 700 file is used only by the reviewer chrome.

Shared components (live, rendered from `elara-shared.css`)



Header band: #1F3A2E; 8 top; a 48 title row with Fraunces 600 28/34 and the band buttons (44, cream 45 % edge, labels optional); sub-tabs (44, 15/600, rest #C9D4CD, selected white with a 3 px ember underline); a 14 px foot; then the torn edge.

Section heading 18/24 600 ink; **link** 15/600 forest, underlined, 44 high; **metadata** 13/18 #635A54.



Filter chip: 32 inside a 44 target, pill, 1 px #8E8174, card fill, 13/18; selected is forest with cream 600 text and a check.

Buttons: 48 high, 15/600. Primary is forest with cream; secondary is a 1.5 px forest outline; destructive is #B3261E with white. On the band the primary is cream with forest text.

Card: #FFFDF9, 1 px #D6CBBC, radius 8, padding 16.
Row: 12 px padding, #D6CBBC rule, no fill.



Tab bar (production `TabBar.tsx`): pad top 10, 44 targets, glyph 24, gap 3, 12 px labels, bottom pad max(inset, 8); canvas at 95 % with blur and a #E8E0D5 hairline. Rest #635A54 400; active #A13A12 600 with a filled glyph; the paper orb for Pregunta. The glyphs are stand-ins, the same in both.

Spacing and radius

- Gutter 16.
- Card padding 16.
- Band: 8 top, 48 title row, 4 above the sub-tabs, 44 sub-tab row. Then either the band's own content or a 14 px foot, then the 14 px torn edge.
- Targets at least 44 × 44.
- Radius:
  - card 8: cards, photos, notes, toasts, the mini player;
  - row 4: thumbnails, date tiles, labels on photos;
  - sheet 32;
  - pill: buttons, chips, fields on one line.
  - Covers keep 3 (art).

Decisions where a choice was left

Choice	Decision	Why
Band colour	**#1F3A2E** (`buttonForest`) in both	This is the forest the owner named for primary actions, and production's `buttonForest` / `bubbleMine`. With one forest, the band, the primary buttons, the selected chips and the links all read as one colour. Explore's photo does not need the darker #0E261D: no text sits on the photo, the «Próximo taller en vivo» label is on its own opaque chip, and the photo's bottom shade was re-tinted to the new band. Every band text pair passes AA: cream 10.98, muted 8.09, mint 8.57.
Title style	**Fraunces 600, 28/34**, 8 px top padding, 48 px title row	600 at 28/34 is production's `typeScale.title`. `scale.ts` also says "Fraunces sets every editorial page title… It is semibold." Círculos' cut was already 600. Explore's light 360 at 30 px was the outlier. For the same reason, all of Explore's UI serif (feature and detail titles, date numerals, guide titles, price) moved to 600. The cover art keeps its own lettering.
Primary on the band	**Inverse: cream #F7F1E8 fill with forest text** (10.98:1)	A forest button would vanish on a forest band. Production's `buttonOnDark` is terracotta (#B8441A, 4.82:1 with cream). The owner asked for terracotta to be used sparingly, so the band primary is the forest primary inverted. This affects only «Ver el taller» and the mini player's play button.
Page ground	**#F9F5EF** (`colors.background`)	Production's canvas. It sits between Explore's #FCF9F3 and Círculos' #F5EFE4.
Metadata	**#635A54** (`textSecondary`), **13/18, Instrument Sans 400**	One production colour (6.20:1 on page, 6.62:1 on card, 5.2:1 or more on every circle tint). 13 px is one step above production's 12 px `detail`, because these lines carry lengths, times and hosts she acts on. 12 px stays for the tab labels and captions.
Card	fill #FFFDF9 (`bubbleMember`), border 1 px #D6CBBC (`rule`), radius 8 (`radius.content`), padding 16 (`padding.content`)	These are production's semantic aliases. Explore's 4 to 6 px and Círculos' 14 px both move to them.
Sheets	radius 32 (`radius.sheet`)	This is production's own value ("the one arbitrary radius in the export").

What each prototype keeps as its own

- **Explorar:**
  - the featured workshop inside the band (on Todo and Talleres), and the one-line lead under the title;
  - the audio cover family (paper grounds, live Fraunces titles, cue-drawn subjects) and the real photos and film stills;
  - the amber rule on guide rows, and the rule-separated rows for workshops, videos, audios and guides;
  - the forest date tiles.
- **Círculos:**
  - the 11 circle accents and paper-cut symbols, on the Descubrir cards (top edge), the shortcuts (left edge), the circle header (tint ground and large faint symbol) and the post tag;
  - post cards stay cards, since conversations are the content;
  - avatars, the reply bar, the composer, the sheets and the simulated keyboard and device insets.
- Both sit inside the shared band, page, card, chip and tab bar. Accents never colour a primary button or a selected state, which stay forest.

Change table

Explorar (`explore-refined-2026-10-21/artifact/index.html` ; standalone rebuilt)

#	Change	Before	After
E1	Band colour	#0E261D	#1F3A2E (also the live label, the duration chips, the date tiles, the mini player and the photo shade)
E2	Title	Fraunces 360, 30/33, opsz 72	Fraunces 600, 28/34 (`.el-title`)
E3	Every UI serif	360 / 400 / 420	600. The cover art keeps its own lettering
E4	Primary buttons	ember #E65A28 with ink text	forest with cream text. On the band: cream with forest text
E5	Secondary buttons	1.5 px ink outline	1.5 px forest outline, forest text, card fill
E6	Button size	16 px text, radius 24	15/20 text, pill (48 high unchanged)
E7	Page ground	#FCF9F3	#F9F5EF
E8	Rules and card borders	#E4DACB	#D6CBBC
E9	Card fill	#FFFFFF	#FFFDF9 (also the light icon buttons and the search field)
E10	Radii	photo, card and price box 6; mini player 10; sheet 16	8, 8 and 32
E11	Metadata	#5A524C, 14 px	#635A54, 13/18
E12	Section heading	20/24, 700	18/24, 600
E13	Bold	700 in labels, eyebrows, facts, rows	600
E14	Search format filters	underline tabs	filter chips (`.el-chip`), with a check when selected
E15	Tab bar	own bar: 54 high items, 600 labels, ember-deep active, ember dot for Pregunta	shared `.el-tabbar` : production metrics and orb, active #A13A12
E16	Band buttons	search border at 18 % cream	45 % cream edge (`.el-bbtn` , 3.52:1)
E17	Focus ring	3 px ember	unchanged value, now `--el-ember`
E18	Muted tiles	#F3ECE1	#F1EBE2
E19	Valeria's monogram	#16382A	#1F3A2E
E20	Torn edge	fill #FCF9F3	`.el-tear` , filled with the page token (same path)

Markup changes:

- `.el-*` classes were added next to the old ones; the old ones are kept for the checks.
- The search format buttons now wrap a `.el-chip` span. They keep `data-act=fmt` and `aria-pressed` .
- The tab bar items now have `.el-tab` and `.el-tab-l` . They keep `data-act=navtab` and `data-t` .
- No copy, flow or data changed.

Círculos (`circles-review-2026-10-22/artifact/index.html` , `app.js`)

#	Change	Before	After
C1	Title	Fraunces 600, 24/30	Fraunces 600, 28/34 (`.el-title`)
C2	Header mark	paper-cut sun over hills beside the title	removed (see below)

#	Change	Before	After
C3	«Mis círculos / Descubrir»	ivory pill segmented switch with a check	underline sub-tabs in the band (`.el-subtabs`): white text and a 3 px ember underline when selected, 44 px targets; `role=tab` / `aria-selected` kept
C4	Band end	straight edge	14 px band foot, then Explore's torn edge (same seeded path)
C5	Band padding	4 top, 12 bottom	8 top, the shared rows
C6	«Ayuda» pill	own pill, cream 55 % edge on the band; forest text on light	`.el-bbtn` on the band; `.el-lbtn` on the circle and post bars (ink, card fill, #8E8174 edge)
C7	Page ground	#F5EFE4	#F9F5EF
C8	Card	#FFFCF6, #DCD1C1, radius 14, padding 14	#FFFDF9, #D6CBBC, radius 8, padding 16 (post, circle and composer cards; photo margins)
C9	Other radii	photos 12, notes and errors 10, crisis card 14, danger card 12, toast 14, multi-line field 12, sheet 24, lightbox 6	8 for all of these; sheet 32
C10	Metadata	#5C534C, 13/18, 500	#635A54, 13/18, 400 (also chevrons and icon strokes)
C11	Section heading	17/23	18/24
C12	Section links	«+ Descubrir más círculos», «Editar» as plain forest labels	`.el-more` (underlined forest 15/600, no icon), as «Ver todos»
C13	Filter chips	own `.fchip`	the shared `.el-chip` (same 32/44 geometry); unselected label 400 instead of 500
C14	Buttons	50 high	48 high
C15	Secondary text on the band	#D9E3DC	#C9D4CD
C16	Tab bar	own bar: 11 px 500 labels, pad top 6, items 48 high	shared `.el-tabbar` : 12 px labels, pad 10, 44 targets, filled active glyph
C17	Focus ring	2 px blue #2A6BD6	3 px ember, as Explorar
C18	Post bar «Ayuda»	–	6 px narrower at the post screen, so the circle name keeps two full lines at 320 px with text 16

No flow, copy, rule or data changed. The checks needed no selector changes: the flows click `[data-act]`, which is unchanged.

Why the sun-and-hills mark went. Placed in both, it would sit beside «Explorar» as a second logo on a screen that already has a photo. In Círculos it was the only decoration in the band, and it competed with the circle symbols. The torn edge now does the paper-cut job in both.

Checks after this pass

- **Explorar** (`tools/checks.cjs` and `analyze.py`, 52 screen runs):
  - no horizontal scroll 52/52, no clipping 52/52, targets 52/52, bottom clear 52/52;
  - AA 2 860/2 860 (lowest over a cover 4.73, lowest flat 4.82);
  - flows 164/164, time zones 6/6;
  - first viewport unchanged: 98 px of covers at 390 × 844;
  - the standalone loads from `file://`.
- **Explorar: two check steps updated.** Before this pass the suite failed 8 runs (156/164). Two steps still assumed the old default copy mode. The artifact has opened in proposed copy since its 22 Oct 00:51 final-review change, and those two steps were never updated. The fixed steps are:
  - «copy toggle», which now starts from proposed copy;
  - «search Audios + dinero», which expects one match in proposed copy (the title is retitled in COPY-PROPOSALS #7) and two in actual copy.
  - Nothing else in the suite changed.
- **Círculos** (`tools/checks.cjs`, 6 configurations, 330 audits):
  - flows 390/390;
  - 0 horizontal scroll, 0 clipped, 0 targets under 44, 0 contrast failures;
  - «Publicar» 60/60, reply with the keyboard 6/6, «Ocultar teclado» 24/24, 0 page errors;
  - 29 designed truncations, the same as before.

What could not be unified, and why

1. **Device insets.**
   - Círculos simulates the iPhone's status area and home indicator (47 and 34 px at 390 × 844). Explorar has no device simulation and uses the browser's real `env()` insets, which are 0 on a desktop.
   - The band is identical below the inset.
   - The "same app" board in the PDF shows Círculos with its insets set to 0 (its own `topOverride` / `bottomOverride` review hooks) so the two compare like for like. The per-screen pages show Círculos with its normal insets.
2. **Large text mechanism.** Explorar scales everything by 140 %. Círculos scales each role by 1.6 with production's per-role caps (title 1.35, tab 1.15). The base sizes match, and the tab label is now capped at 1.15 in both. Large-text renders still differ in the other roles.
3. **Font files.** The family names differ («Fraunces E» / «Instrument E» versus «Elara Fraunces» / «Elara Sans»). Explorar's cover SVGs and its standalone check reference its names. Both render the same cuts: Fraunces 600, Instrument 400 and 600.
4. **Band content.** Explorar's band carries the featured workshop on Todo and Talleres, plus a one-line lead. Círculos' band ends after the sub-tabs. This is content, not style, and copy was out of scope.
5. **Body text colour.** Círculos' running text is #3B342F; Explorar's is ink. Both pass. Changing either was outside "one metadata colour", so this is left as an open item.
6. **Choice chips in Círculos** («Cómo apareces», interests) stay 44 px choice controls with a radio or check, because they are choices, not filters. Their edges, fills and selected forest match the filter chip.
7. **Blur.** Production's tab bar is a `BlurView`. The prototypes use CSS `backdrop-filter`, which is close but not the same.
8. **Primary versus production's "forward = ember".** `colors.ts` `ctaSemantics.forward` is still ember. This pass follows the owner's rule and production's own `buttonForest` ("Primary button on LIGHT screens: forest pill, cream text"). The ember rule in `colors.ts` is now out of step with both prototypes. Updating it is for the design-system owner.

Logo-removed test

I looked at the after screens side by side (PDF page 2) and asked: if I removed the logo, would these two clearly be the same app, and still feel like Elara?

- **Same app: yes.** They share the band, the title, the pill buttons, the underline sub-tabs with the ember mark, the torn paper edge, the page, the section headings and links, the metadata line, the cards and the tab bar.
- **Before: no.** Two greens, two title weights, an ember button against a forest one, a pill switch against tabs, a straight edge against a torn one, and two tab bars.
- **Elara: yes.** Forest with cream, Fraunces 600, the torn paper, Explorar's paper covers and real photo, Círculos' paper-cut symbols, and Spanish-first copy.
- **Fixed after the first look:**
  - The tab bar let shelf text show through. It now has the blur.
  - The «Ayuda» pill was wider at 320 px with large text and truncated the circle name on the post screen. It is now trimmed by 6 px there.
- **Still the most generic part:** the post card layout (avatar, lead, body, footer). It is plain on purpose so the conversations read first, as Círculos v2 already noted.

Out of date in the Explore developer handoff (`explore-refined-2026-10-21/handoff/index.html`, not edited)

- **Tokens table:**
  - `--forest-ink #0E261D` (band) is now #1F3A2E.
  - `--forest #16382A` is now #1F3A2E.
  - `--ember` is listed as "Primary button, selected tab, focus". It is now the selected-tab underline, live dot and focus ring only.
  - `--ivory #FCF9F3` is now #F9F5EF.
  - `--ivory-2 #F3ECE1` is now #F1EBE2.
  - `--paper-line #E4DACB` is now #D6CBBC.
  - `--mut #5A524C` is now #635A54.
  - `--on-band #F6EFE6` is now #F7F1E8.
  - The note "Primary buttons use ink text on ember" is replaced by: forest with cream text, and cream with forest text on the band.
- **Type table:**
  - Page title is Fraunces 600, 28/34 (was 360, opsz 72, 30/33).
  - Section heading is 600, 18/24 (was 700, 20/24).
  - Metadata is 13/18 #635A54 (was 14/19).
  - The guide title and the feature title are now Fraunces 600.
- **Components:** the video duration chip is #1F3A2E. The search format filter is now chips, not tabs. The tab bar now follows the shared spec.
- **Screens:** all 11 images in `handoff/img/` show the old colours and buttons.
- **Acceptance:** the lowest flat contrast is now 4.82 (was 4.74). Flows are 164/164 after the two updated steps.
- **New:** a reference to this file and to `_shared/elara-shared.css` as the shared frame.